BYD UK: strong growth, rising policy risk

How long can BYD's UK growth last? Public data to 20 Oct 2026

2025 UK REGISTRATIONS

51,422

≈5.9× the 2024 level

2026 JAN–SEP REGISTRATIONS

68,100

Own calculation · ≈3.9% share

SEPTEMBER 2026 MARKET SHARE

5.75%

Record month · No.2 brand in the UK

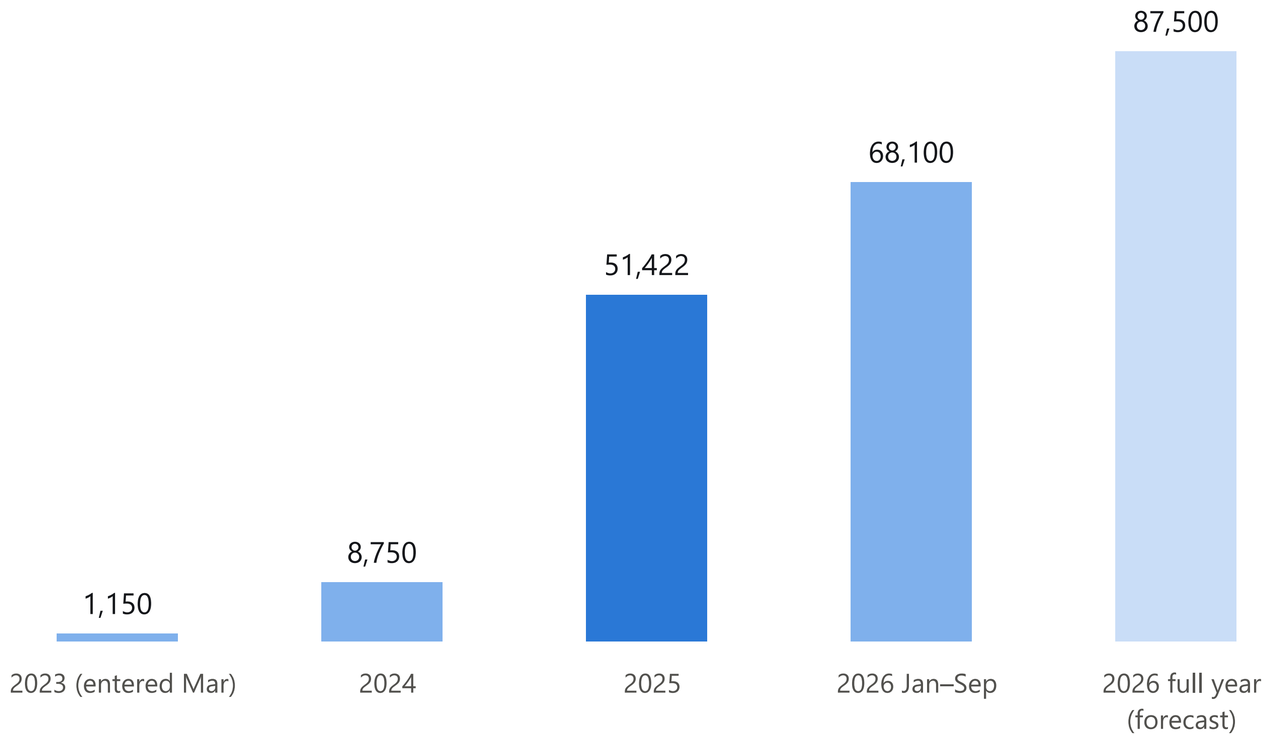
JAN–SEP SALES FROM PLATE MONTHS

52%

March + September only

UK registrations by year

2026 full year = forecast



CURRENT SCENARIO READING

Base: growth slows

Calculated from the five signals on the Scenarios page

Three key findings

1 Growth is real but concentrated: March and September made up 52% of Jan–Sep 2026 sales.

2 Growth rides on outside conditions: no UK tariffs, the ZEV mandate, and hybrids allowed until 2035.

3 The biggest risk is policy: the Electric Car Grant excludes BYD, the 2030 ZEV target may fall from 80% to 50%, and tariffs are being discussed.

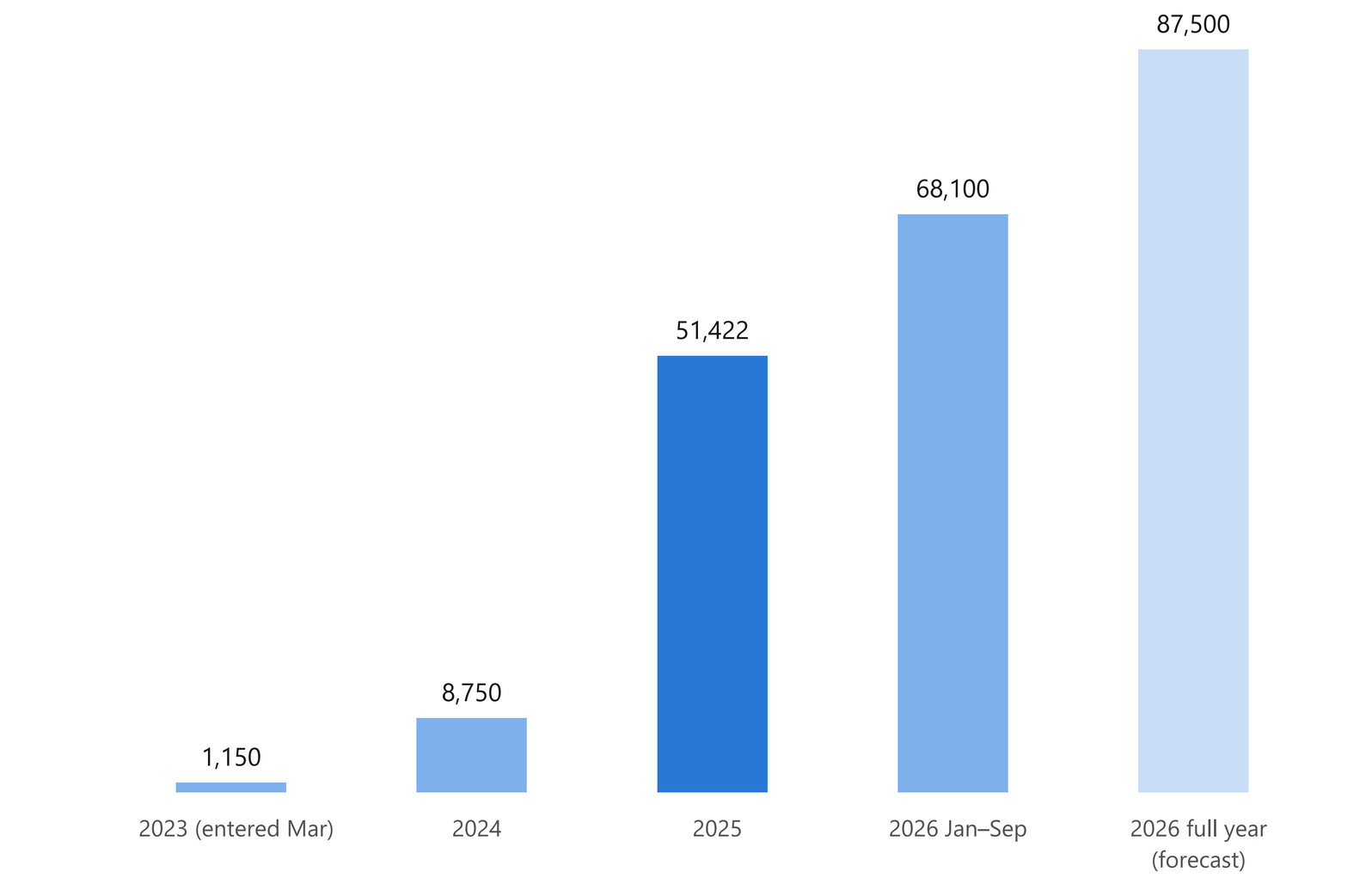
Sources: BYD, SMMT via media (S08–S13, N1–N6). Own calculations marked in the data file.

From ~1,150 cars to a forecast ~87,500 in four years

BYD UK new-car registrations, 2023–2026F · lighter bars are derived or forecast figures

BYD UK registrations by year

Error bar = forecast range



GROWTH, 2024 → 2025

5.9×

≈8,750 → 51,422 registrations

FORECAST GROWTH, 2026

+70%

Own estimate · low confidence

How reliable is each bar?

Reported: published by BYD or SMMT (high confidence).

Derived: own calculation from published figures.

Forecast: Jan–Sep plus Q4 at 5,000–6,500 cars a month.

Growth is slowing as the base grows: about +485% in 2025, about +70% expected in 2026.

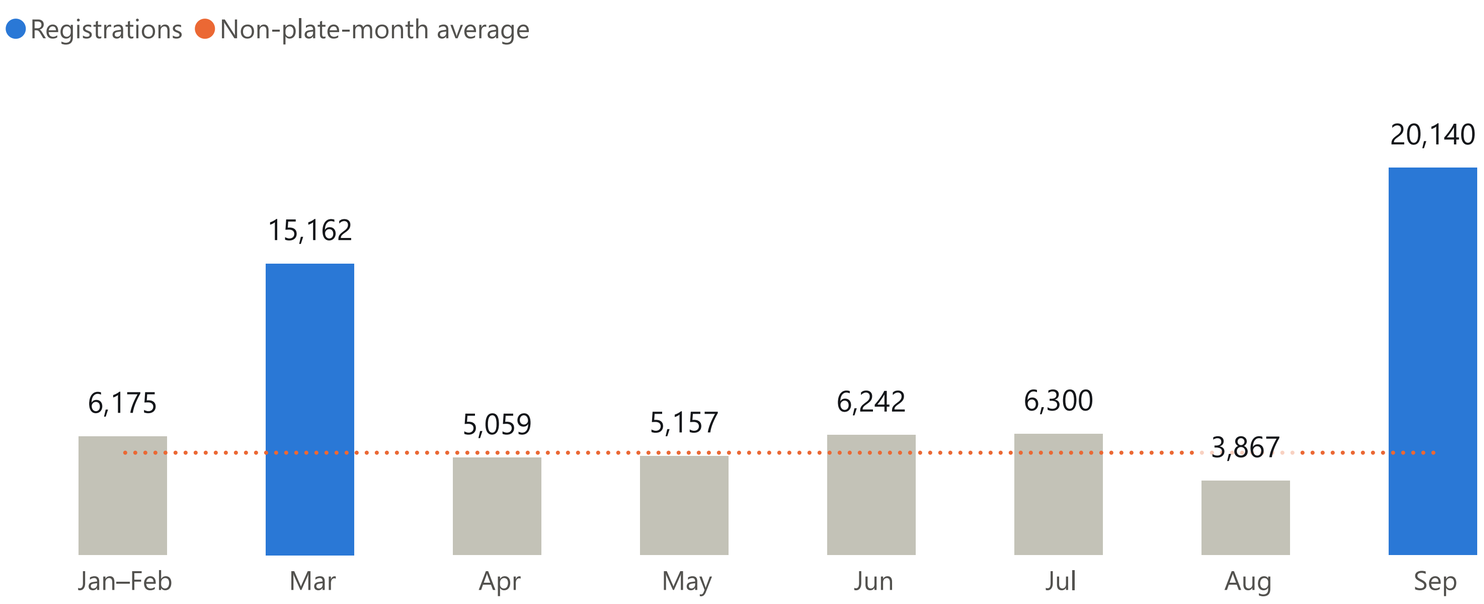
Sources: S08–S10, N4. 2023, 2024 and 2026 figures are own calculations or estimates (low confidence).

Plate months drive more than half of 2026 sales

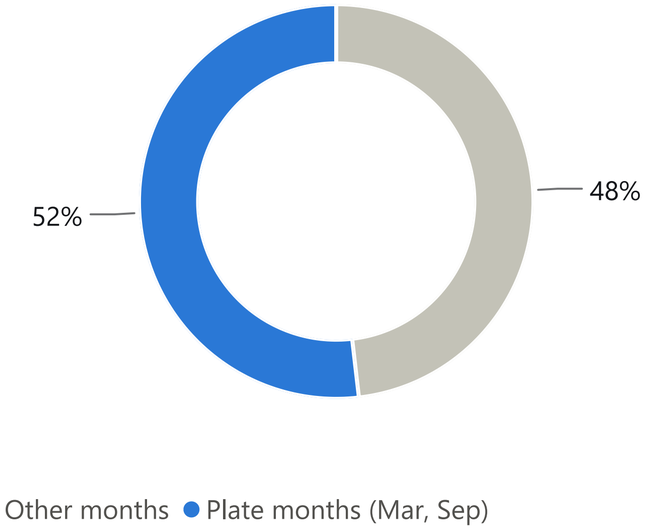
BYD UK registrations by month, 2026 · March and September are new number-plate months

Monthly registrations vs non-plate-month average

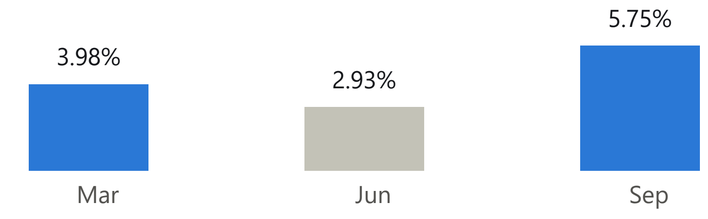
Blue = plate month



Share of Jan–Sep sales



Market share in months with data



What this means

September's 5.75% share is a seasonal peak, not the normal level. In June, a non-plate month, it was 2.93%.

The full-year share is more likely around 4%. The real test of BYD's competitiveness is the grey months.

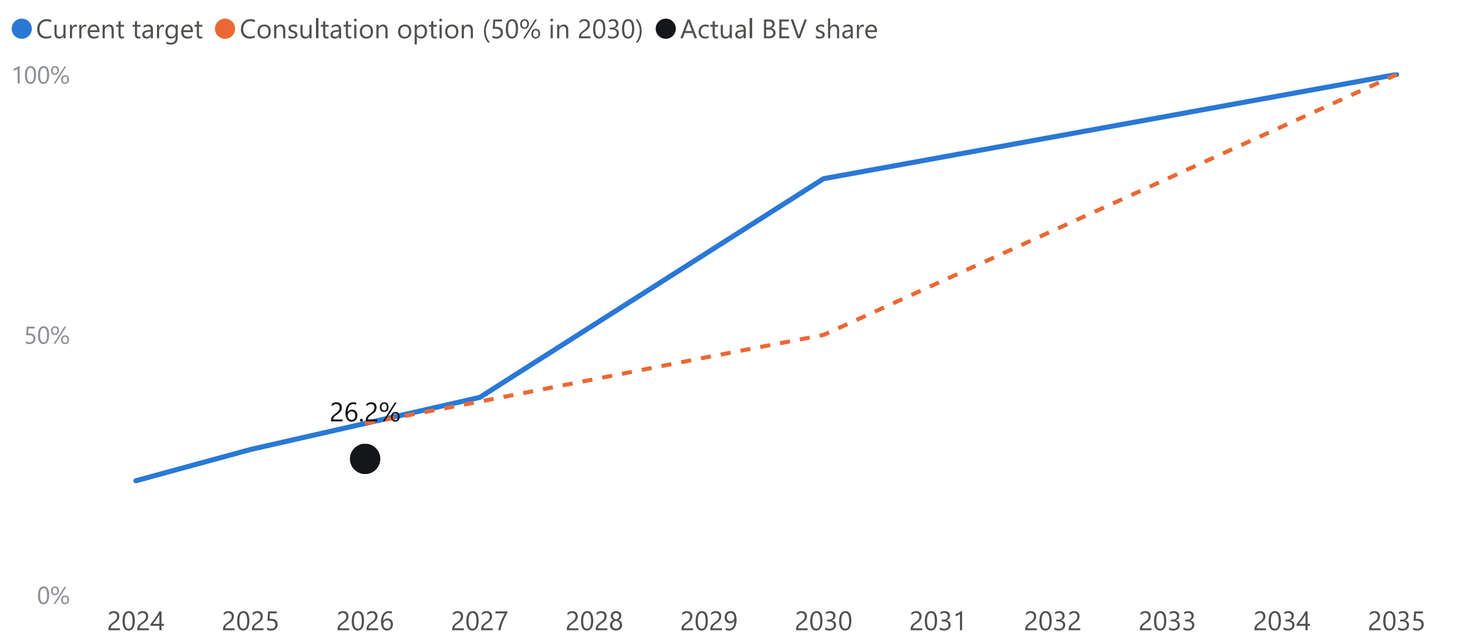
Sources: S08, S11, S12, S18, N1, N2. Jan–Feb, Apr and Jul are derived figures.

The ZEV mandate pushes the market, but targets may be cut

UK ZEV car targets vs actual BEV share, and the policy timeline

ZEV target vs actual BEV share

Dashed = consultation option



2026 GAP TO THE ZEV TARGET

-6.8 pp

BEV share 26.2% (Jan–Sep) vs 33% target

Why it matters for BYD

If the 2030 target falls from 80% to 50%, rivals face less pressure to discount EVs. That weakens BYD's price edge and the value of ZEV credits. The result is expected in early 2027.

Policy timeline

Green = tailwind · Orange = headwind · Grey = uncertain

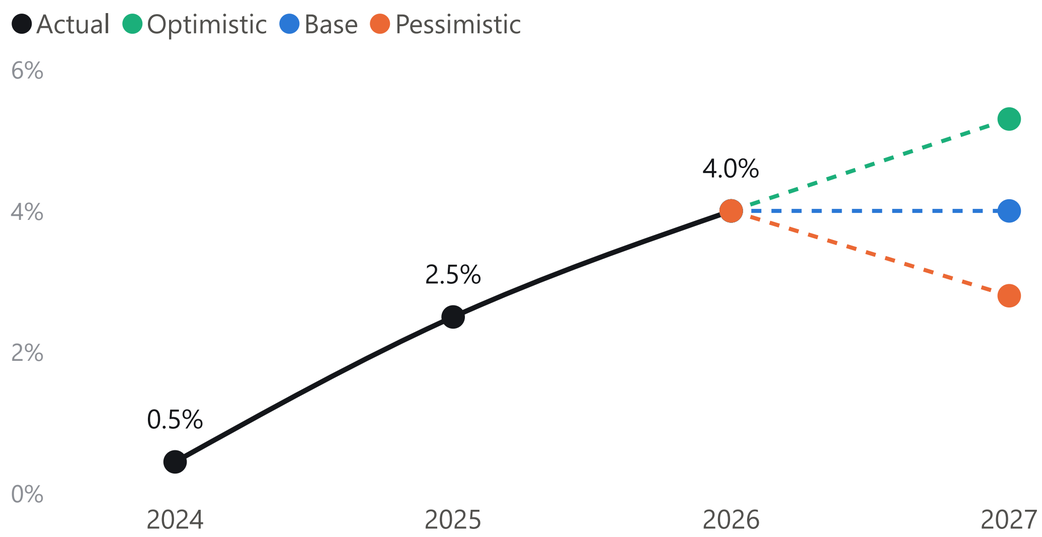
Date	Event	Category	Direction
Mar 2027	Expected: ZEV consultation result	ZEV	Uncertain
Dec 2026	BYD Szeged (Hungary) plant mass production expected	Company	Tailwind
Oct 2026	ZEV consultation closes	ZEV	Uncertain
Oct 2026	Times: UK ministers considering tariffs on Chinese EVs	Tariff	Uncertain

Sources: GOV.UK ZEV consultation, BVRLA, N3, N5. 2027–2029 targets not individually verified; consultation path between years is illustrative.

Three scenarios for 2027, and the signals to watch

Not a forecast: which path BYD follows depends on policy · readings updated monthly after SMMT data

BYD UK market share: actual and scenarios



OPTIMISTIC

Growth continues

2027 share

5%+

If: ZEV targets kept, no tariffs.

Prepare: expand dealers, push fleet sales.

BASE · MOST LIKELY

Growth slows

2027 share

≈4%

If: 2030 target cut to ~50%, grant still excludes BYD.

Prepare: lean on hybrids and running-cost value.

PESSIMISTIC

Growth stops

2027 share

≈2.8%

If: UK tariffs on China-built EVs.

Prepare: supply from Hungary plant, pricing plans.

Five early-warning signals

Check after each SMMT release (~4th of the month)

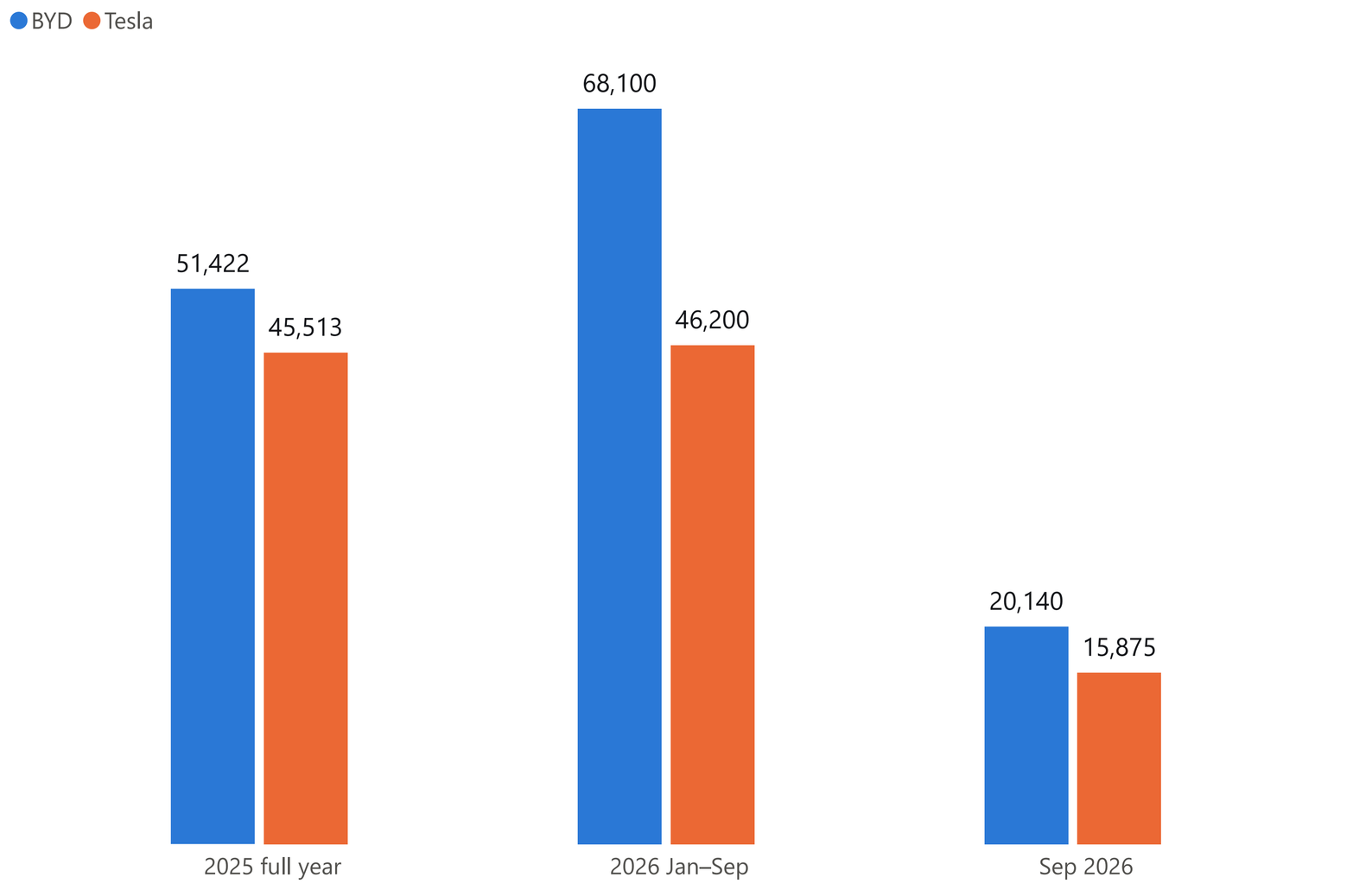
#	Signal	Latest value	Period	Optimistic if	Pessimistic if	Reading	Next check
1	BYD share in non-plate months	2.93%	Jun 2026	Above 3.5%	Below 2.5%	Base	5 Nov 2026
2	UK BEV share vs ZEV target	26.2% vs 33%	Jan–Sep 2026	Gap closing	Gap widening	Base	5 Nov 2026
3	ZEV consultation outcome	Closed 23 Oct 2026; 3 of 4 options cut 2030 to 50%	Oct 2026	80% kept	Cut below 50%	Base	31 Jan 2027
4	UK tariffs on China-built EVs	Times reports ministers considering; no decision	4 Oct 2026	Ruled out	Tariff plan published	Watch	30 Nov 2026
5	ECG grant list includes BYD	No BYD models listed	Oct 2026	BYD model added	Grant extended, BYD still excluded	Base	30 Nov 2026

2024–2026 shares are own calculations; 2027 values are scenario assumptions, not forecasts.

BYD outsells Tesla in the UK, counting hybrids

UK and Europe registrations · BYD includes plug-in hybrids, Tesla sells battery EVs only

BYD vs Tesla registrations



BYD LEAD, UK JAN–SEP 2026

+21,900

≈68,100 vs ≈46,200

Europe, H1 2026

Level: both brands at 2.4% share (174,144 vs 170,351).

Price or premium?

BYD is seen as the cheaper choice; Tesla has the tech and brand halo.

The Electric Car Grant gives rivals up to £3,750 off, so price alone may not keep BYD ahead.

BYD's driver-assist, fast-charging and battery tech could make it "affordable and advanced".

Sources: S08–S10, S17, N3. BYD Jan–Sep is an own calculation; Tesla ~46,200 is a media estimate.

Where the numbers come from

Every figure has a source ID and confidence level · full list in BYD_Data_Collection_2026-10-20.xlsx

Sources

Click a link to open

SourceID	Title	URL
N1	Rivervale – BYD UK H1 registrations +95% (Jun 6,242, 2.93%)	
N2	EHVTI – BYD UK record Q1 21,337 (Mar 15,162, 3.98%)	
N3	eletric-vehicles.com – Tesla UK Sep 15,875; UK BEV share 26.2% YTD	
N4	Fleet News – BYD 2024 UK sales 8,700 (+658%)	
N5	TimesLive/Reuters – UK said to be mulling tariffs on Chinese EVs (6 Oct 2026)	
N6	eletric-vehicles.com – BYD UK H1 2026 37,795	
S01	CnEVPost – BYD 2025 full-year results	
S02	CnEVPost – BYD H1 2026 earnings	
S03	CnEVPost – BYD September 2026 sales	
S04	RoadGenius – BYD sales 2026 monthly data	
S05	CMBI broker report (quarterly table, 31 Aug 2026)	
S06	Yahoo Finance – BYD Q1 2026 profit falls 55%	
S07	Nikkei Asia – BYD targets 2m overseas sales in 2026	
S08	BYD UK Media – record September 2026	
S09	Cathay EV – BYD UK 48,000 registrations, 3.48% share	
S10	Car Dealer Magazine – Chinese brands in UK 2025	
S11	The EV Report – BYD UK best-selling EV brand YTD	
S12	eletric-vehicles.com – BYD UK H1 sales nearly double	
S13	The EV Report – BYD passes 100,000 UK sales	
S14	Motor Trade News – BYD UK 125th retailer	
S15	Fleet News – BYD enters UK (2023)	
S16	Automotive Logistics – no UK production	
S17	eletric-vehicles.com – BYD & Tesla same European share H1 2026	
S18	evstats.org – Tesla vs BYD in Europe, Aug 2026	
S19	eletric-vehicles.com – BYD Germany sales	
S20	Börse Express – BYD Europe sales tripled	

Confidence levels

High: company announcement or primary data.

Medium: reputable secondary report, e.g. SMMT figures quoted by media.

Low: estimate or single source, e.g. 2023 registrations, 2026 forecast.

Limits

Jan–Feb, Apr and Jul 2026 are derived and may be a few hundred cars out.

No public BEV/PHEV or fleet/private split for BYD UK.

The tariff story is a media report; no government decision.

Correction: H1 2026 = 37,795 (not 37,995).